EXP_2026Q2_EMAIL_SUBJECT · PRE-REGISTERED DESIGN BRIEF · OPERATOR
LIFECYCLE · EMAIL · SEALED 2026-06-05T15:42:30Z · DURATION 14 DAYS

Order confirmation email — subject line copy

Changing the order confirmation email subject from 'Your order is on the way' to 'Tracking your order #{N}' increases repeat purchase rate by making it easier to find the email later.

AT A GLANCE

Primary metric is *conversion_rate*; decision is binary against Ship if repeat_purchase_rate CI excludes zero on benefit side.

Pre-registered before any analysis. Decision is binary against conversion_rate: a 2.0% relative relative lift over a 10.0% baseline requires 20,000 per arm at the standard a / power settings. Guardrails sit on revenue_per_user.

SAMPLE REQUIRED (PER ARM)

20,000

to detect a 2.0% relative relative effect at a = 0.05, power = 0.80

BASELINE
10.0%

TOTAL SAMPLE
40,000

DURATION
14 days

FEASIBILITY
VIABLE

MECHANISM

Why we think this works

Order numbers in subjects make emails findable by search. Easier-to-find shipment emails could lead to higher re-engagement and more repeat purchases over the following 14 days.

Email open rate baseline ~22%, repeat purchase rate within 14 days ~10%. No subject-line tests have shipped in the past year.

METRICS

conversion_rate is the verdict-driving metric.

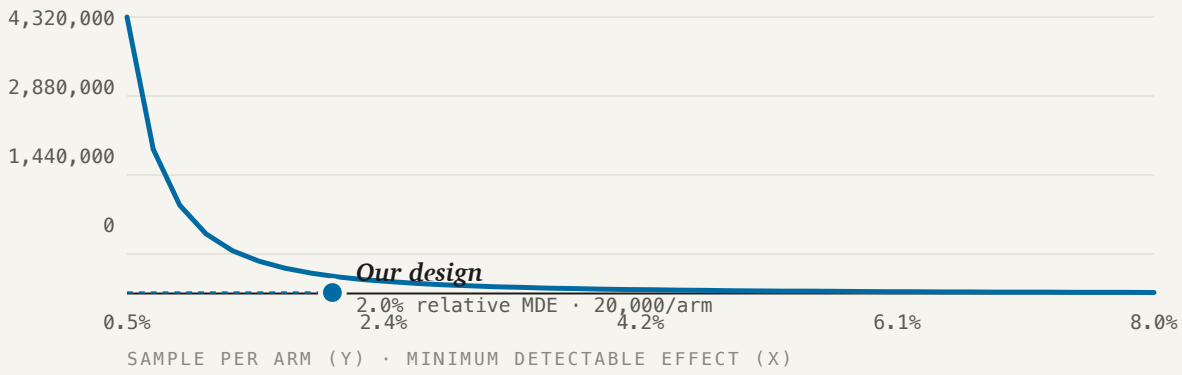
Primary is conversion_rate; secondaries inform interpretation but do not influence the verdict. Guardrails block ship if their 90% CI lies past the pre-registered harm boundary.

PRIMARY	**conversion_rate** Proportion · baseline 10.0% · MDE 2.0% relative · direction higher is better
SECONDARY	**email_open_rate** Leading indicator. Not used for the ship/no-ship decision but informs interpretation.
GUARDRAIL	**revenue_per_user** Direction higher is better. Decision blocks if 90% CI lies past -5.0% relative.

POWER

Detecting smaller effects requires much more sample.

To resolve a 2.0% relative relative effect against a 10.0% baseline, we need 20,000 per arm. Tighter detection thresholds would climb the curve to the left — quickly.



Smaller effects require disproportionately more sample. Our design point is feasible inside the available user_id surface.

ASSIGNMENT + COHORTS

First-exposure attribution at the user_id level.

Each user is randomly assigned at first exposure to control or treatment in a 50 / 50 split. Events before first_exposure_at are not attributed to the experiment.

UNIT	**user_id** One row per (user_id, experiment_id) in the assignments table; first_exposure_at gates which events are attributed.
ARMS	**50 / 50** control · treatment

COHORT	**all assigned users**

DECISION RULES

Pre-registered. The analyze verb walks the same tree against the same metrics.

Ship if repeat_purchase_rate CI excludes zero on benefit side. Conservative — small effects are not worth the email-channel risk.

SHIP	Primary 95% CI excludes zero on benefit side · no guardrail breach · novelty late-ratio ≥ 0.7
LIFT WITH CAVEAT	Real lift but below MDE/2 — surface the caveat in the readout but still consider rolling out
NO-SHIP · GUARDRAIL	Any guardrail's 90% CI lies past its harm threshold
NO-LIFT	Well-powered, primary CI straddles zero with half-width > 2 × MDE
INCONCLUSIVE	Underpowered (n < required) AND primary CI straddles zero
INVALID	SRM χ^2 $p < 0.0005$ and no override resolved — investigate assignment